

Competitive Analysis

Sarvam benchmarked against five alternatives across ten dimensions — and the argument that its most dangerous competitor is domestic, not American.

COMPETITORS	DIMENSIONS	RATING SCALE	CLOSEST PEER
5	10	Qualitative, deliberately	Krutrim (Ola)

METHODOLOGY NOTE

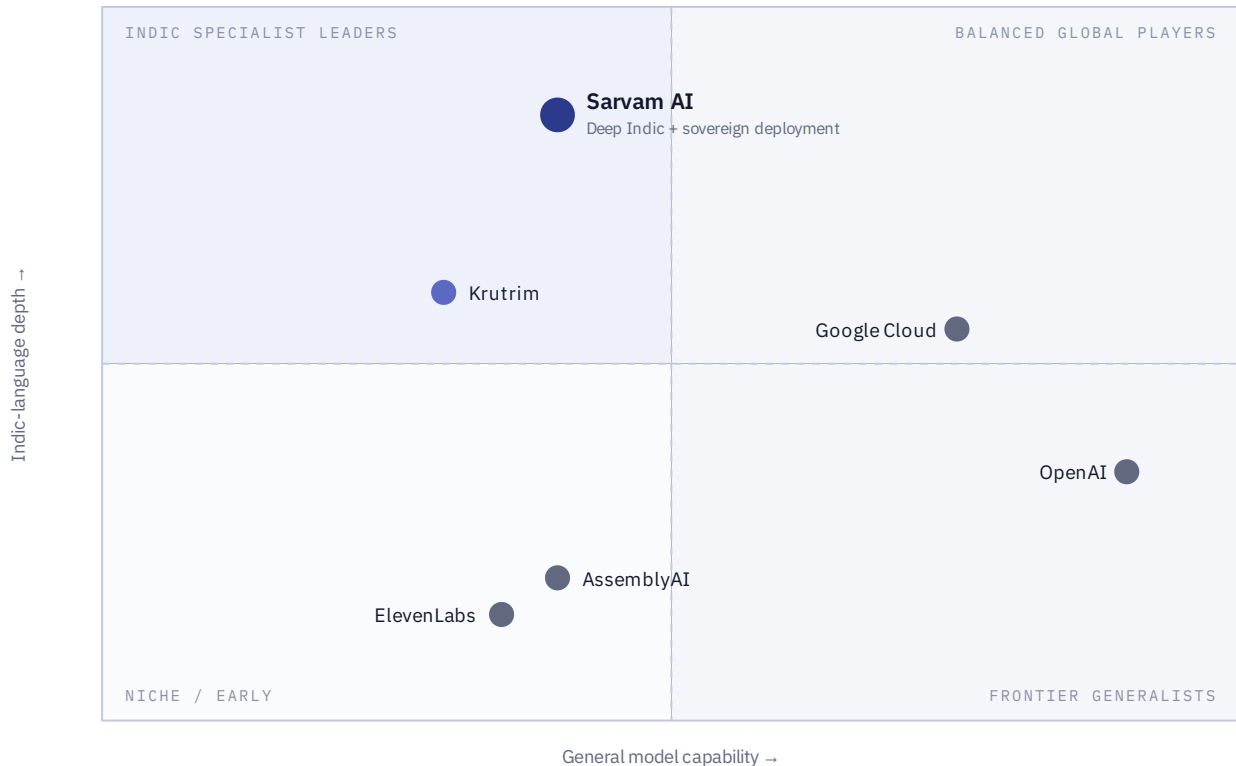
Ratings are **qualitative** and based on publicly available documentation, pricing pages, and third-party comparisons as of August 2026 — deliberately *not* a numeric scoring model. Assigning 1–10 scores without access to real benchmark data or usage figures would look rigorous while being misleading. Where a genuine benchmark number exists, it is cited directly instead.

8.1 Competitive matrix

DIMENSION	SARVAM AI	OPENAI	GOOGLE CLOUD	ELEVENLABS	ASSEMBLYAI	KRUTRIM (OLA)
Indian-language breadth	22 languages, production + beta	Major Indian languages only	10+ Indian languages	Limited	Limited	10+ Indian languages
Code-mixed / Hinglish handling	Strong — native training	Weak–Moderate	Moderate	Weak	Weak	Moderate
Developer API	REST + Python / JS SDK	Yes — mature	Yes — mature	Yes, TTS-focused	Yes, STT-focused	Yes — early
General reasoning capability	Moderate — Indic-specialised	Very strong (frontier)	Strong	N/A	N/A	Emerging
Voice stack completeness	Full stack — ASR + TTS + agents	ASR strong, TTS via partners	Full stack	TTS best-in-class	ASR best-in-class	Emerging
Pricing transparency	High — public ₹ table	High — public \$ table	High	High	High	Moderate
Ease of integration	Moderate — many APIs to pick from	High	High	High	High	Moderate
Documentation quality	Good — /llms.txt for agents	Excellent	Excellent	Good	Good	Developing
Deployment options	Cloud + sovereign / air-gapped	Cloud only	Cloud + some on-prem	Cloud only	Cloud only	Cloud + India-hosted
Data residency in India	Yes — structural moat	No	Partial	No	No	Yes

Shaded cells mark dimensions where Sarvam holds a defensible advantage over the full comparison set.

8.2 Positioning map



SARVAM DELIBERATELY OCCUPIES THE TOP-LEFT: MAXIMUM INDIC DEPTH, MID GENERAL CAPABILITY

8.3 Key takeaways

- The moat is depth plus sovereignty, not breadth**
Sarvam wins decisively on Indic-language accuracy and India-hosted deployment. It does not compete on frontier general reasoning, and pretending otherwise would misdirect the roadmap.
- Krutrim is the closest strategic peer**
Also India-native, also IndiaAI-aligned. That makes it the most direct long-term competitive threat — more so than the global giants, because it is competing for the same sovereignty narrative and the same government relationships.
- Hyperscalers are a distribution threat, not a quality threat**
Google, AWS, and Azure bundle AI with infrastructure enterprises already buy. That is a go-to-market risk far more than a technical one, and it is answered with partnerships and procurement strategy rather than better models.
- Documentation and ecosystem maturity is the most fixable gap**
Relative to OpenAI and Google, this is where classic product investment — better docs, SDKs, worked examples — closes distance quickly, unlike model-quality gaps that take years. This is the opening the rest of the case study walks through.